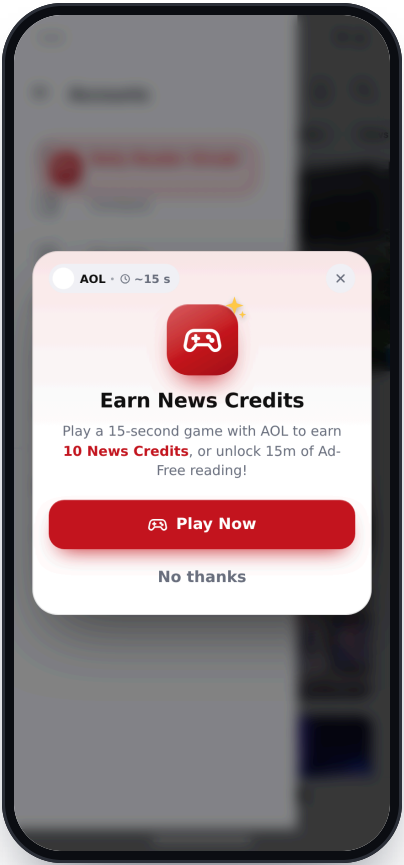
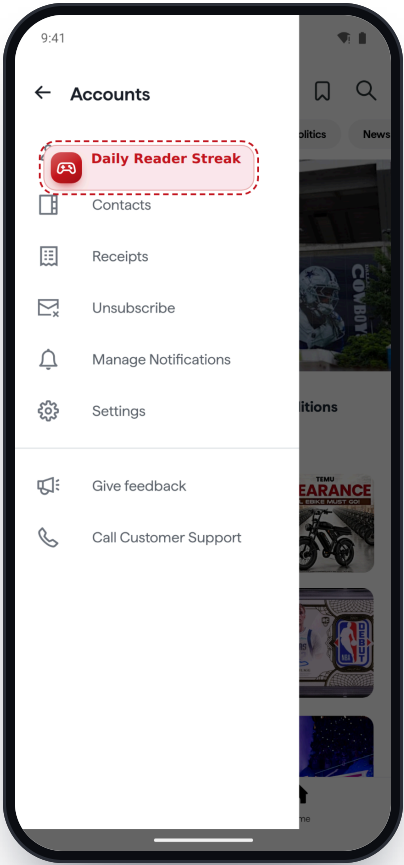


Let users **play a short game for a reward.**

Add two opt-in rewarded flows to AOL that trade a short sponsored game for something users already value. We reviewed 3 ideas: 2 ship, 0 need revision, 1 rejected.



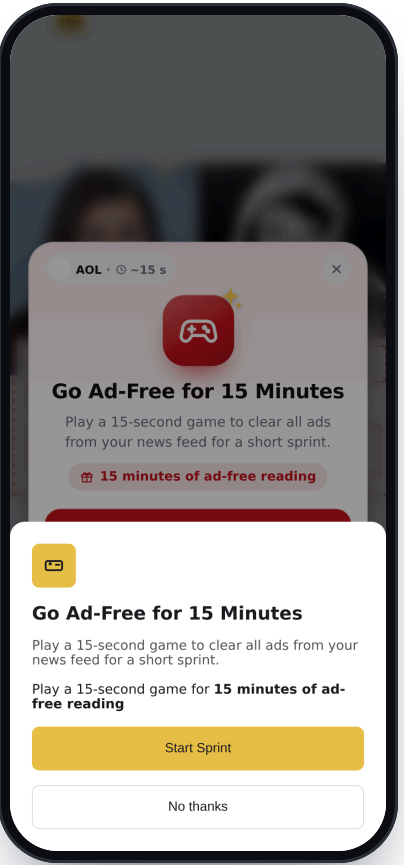
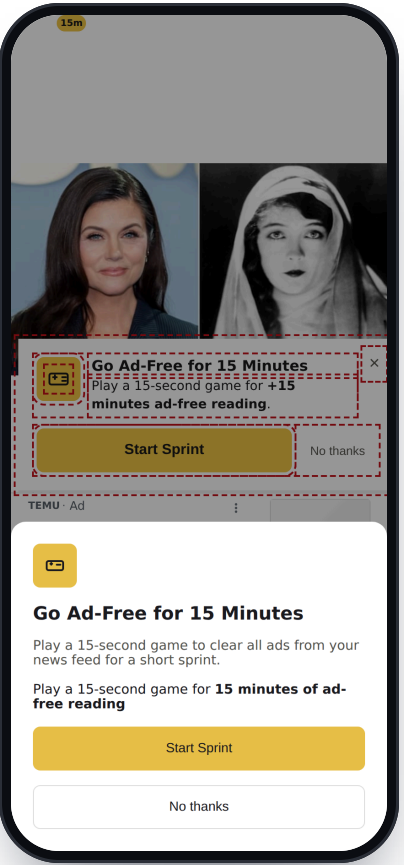
1 FLOW 1 · SLIDE 3

**Account Menu Sidebar:
play for 10 News Credits**

Earn News Credits daily via streaks to unlock 15-minute ad-free news reading sessions.

SHIP Score 4.80 / 5 (ship ≥ 3.8)

Product change



2 FLOW 2 · SLIDE 5

Go Ad-Free for 15 Minutes

Enjoy 15 minutes of ad-free news reading after a quick game.

SHIP Score 4.20 / 5 (ship ≥ 3.8)

Product change

ONE COMPLETED VIEW EARNS

\$0.009–\$0.015

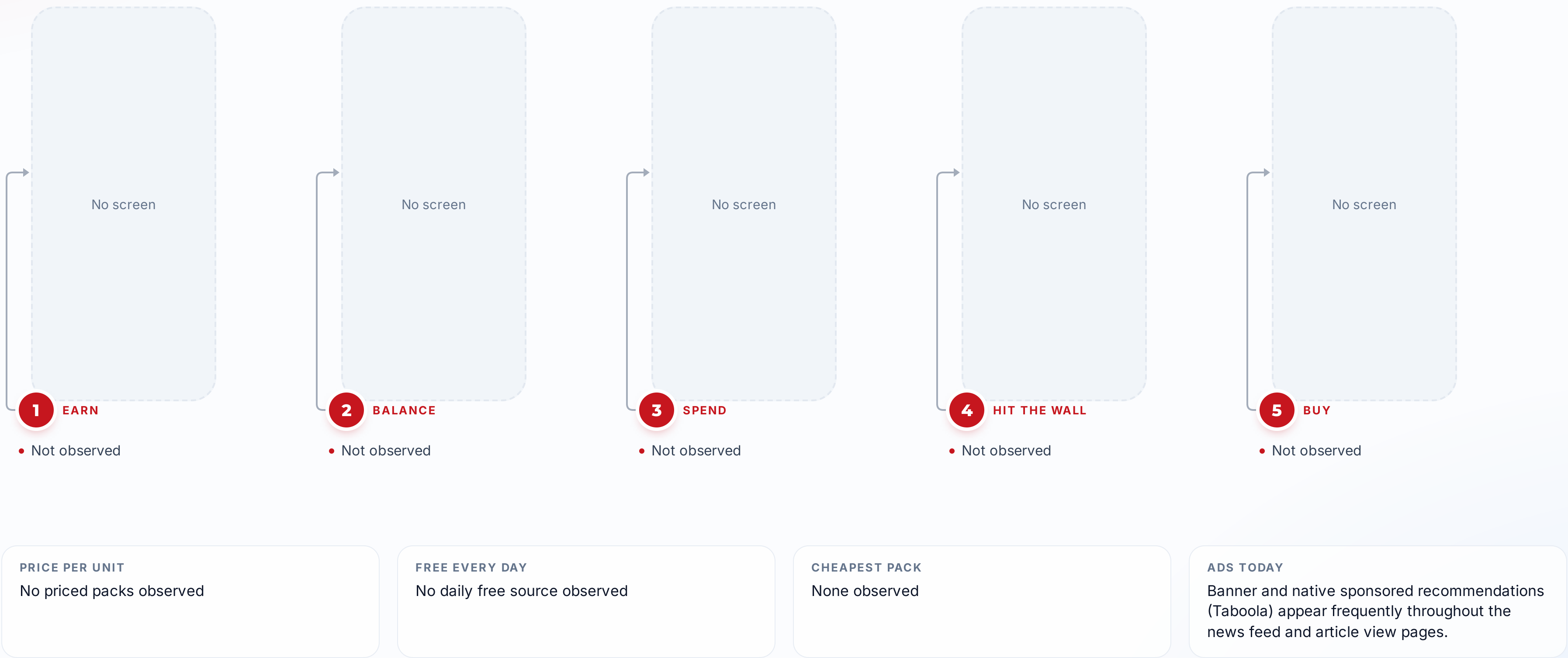
US rewarded eCPM after a non-game haircut, about \$0.0063 net at the low end. The app shows no prices, so there is no exchange rate in its own units; every reward on these slides costs less than that to serve. In LATAM a view earns \$0.0015–\$0.003.

CHEAPEST PACK

No priced pack was observed, so there is no paid path to cannibalize in currency terms.

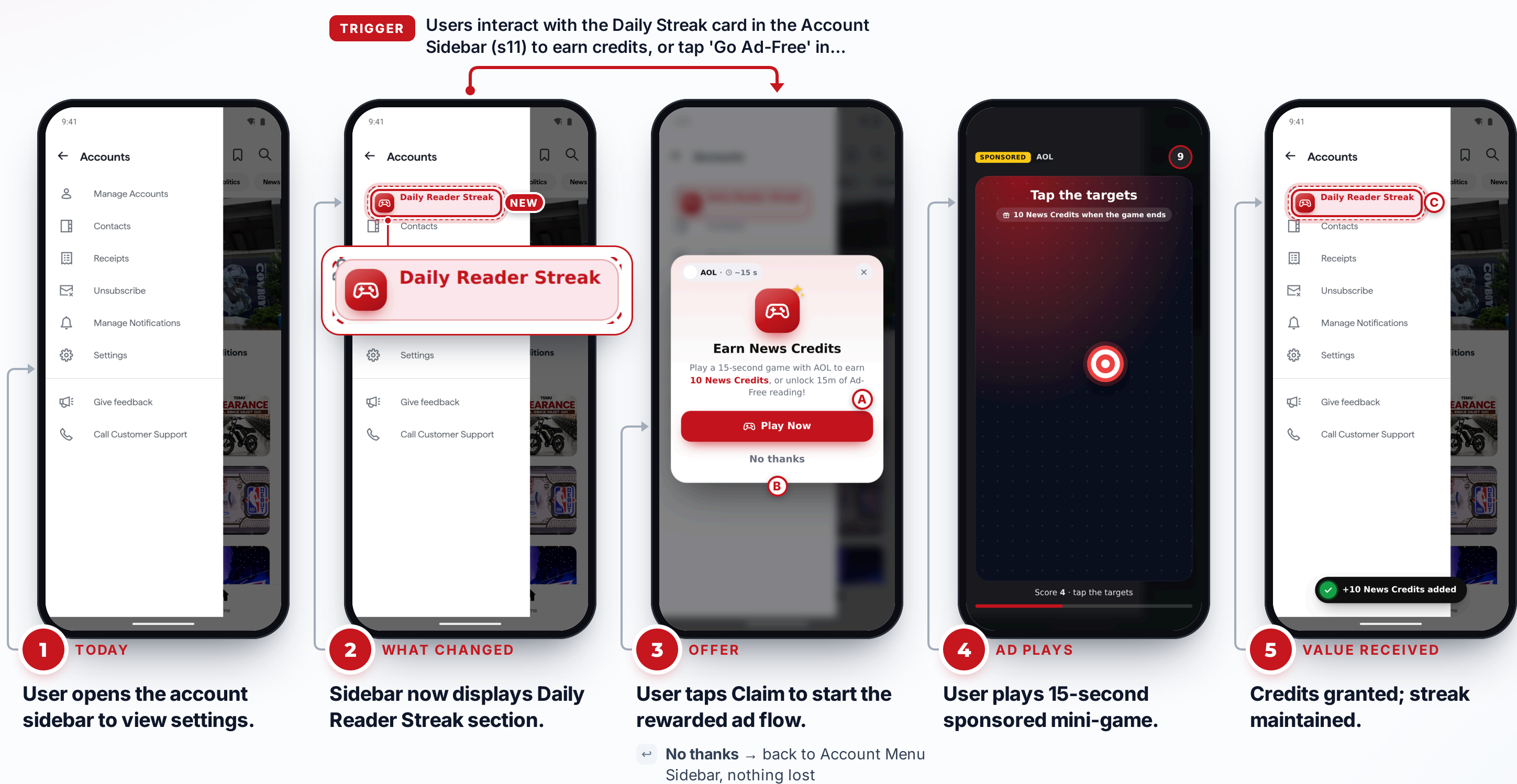
How AOL makes money today

Monetizes primarily through native and display advertisements (such as Taboola advertising units) embedded within news feeds and article pages. Real screens from the app; prices and costs as observed.



Account Menu Sidebar: play for 10 News Credits

Earn News Credits daily via streaks to unlock 15-minute ad-free news reading sessions.



SHIP Score 4.80 / 5 (ship ≥ 3.8)

Product change

WHY THIS WORKS

\$0.009–\$0.015 per view

Earned per completed US view; the reward costs ≈ \$0 to serve.

Paid path untouched

The reward is a small, time-boxed sample of ad-free reading (15m) that provides a 'taste' of premium value...

≤ 3 a day

Opt-in only, at least 30 min apart; nothing plays unless the user taps.

Open the clickable prototype →

Simula SIM-RWD · button entry · Game Partner: AOL · min play 15s · reward granted on REWARD_VERIFIED · frame callouts on slide 4

Daily Reader Streak & Ad-Free Access

TRIGGER

Users interact with the Daily Streak card in the Account Sidebar (s11) to earn credits, or tap 'Go Ad-Free' in Article Details (s03) to redeem credits for ad-free reading.

ELIGIBILITY

Non-signed-in users and signed-in non-subscribers who have not claimed today's reward.

WHAT THE USER SEES

Earn News Credits Play a 15-second game with AOL to earn 10 News Credits, or unlock 15m of Ad-Free reading!

Play Now

No thanks

REWARD AND CAPS

10 News Credits; granted on REWARD_VERIFIED. At most 3 a day, 30 min apart.

FRAME BY FRAME (SLIDE 3)

- 1

Today

User opens the account sidebar to view settings.

Existing account menu
- 2

What changed

Sidebar now displays Daily Reader Streak section.

NEW

streak card
- 3

Offer

User taps Claim to start the rewarded ad flow.

A

Play Now: starts a 15s sponsored game

B

No thanks: dismisses the offer

Claim reward
- 4

Ad plays

User plays 15-second sponsored mini-game.
- 5

Value received

Credits granted; streak maintained.

C

Streak earned!

ECONOMICS (COMPUTED IN CODE)

Revenue per completed US view	\$0.009–\$0.015
Reward value at list price	n/a (no priced unit)
Reward ÷ one view	n/a
Max earnable per day (3/day)	n/a
Cheapest pack	none observed
Cost to serve the reward	\$0 per view

SCENARIO, NOT FORECAST

0.4

\$0.0048

\$1,752,000

views per DAU

ARPDau

per year per 1M DAU

Scenario, not a forecast: 20% of DAU engage, 2 views each, US mid eCPM after a 25% non-game haircut.

CANNIBALIZATION GUARD

The reward is a small, time-boxed sample of ad-free reading (15m) that provides a 'taste' of premium value, encouraging upgrade intent without giving away unlimited ad-free access. Offers are gated...

KPI AND HOLDOUT

D7 Retention; guardrails: Average Sessions Per DAU, Paid Subscription Conversion Rate. User-level randomization, 10% share, 28-day duration

RISKS

- Users may find the redemption utility insufficient if not clearly communicated.
- Potential fatigue if the streak mechanic is perceived as mandatory.

INTEGRATION (@SIMULA/ADS-REACT-NATIVE)

```
import { SimulaAds, useRewardedAd, MiniGameButton } from "@simula/ads-react-native";
import { useEffect, useState } from "react";

// P3 on "Account Menu Sidebar". Trigger: Users interact with the Daily Streak card
in the Account Sidebar (s11) to earn credits,...
// Caps 3/day, 30 min apart: app remote config (unit cap: dashboard)
const AD_UNIT = "SIM-RWD-account-menu-sidebar"; // placeholder: create it in the
dashboard

export function DailyReaderStreakOffer({ userId, partnerImageUrl, grant, onDecline })
{
  const rwd = useRewardedAd(AD_UNIT);
  const [capped, setCapped] = useState(true);
  useEffect(() => {
    SimulaAds.checkFrequencyCap(AD_UNIT, userId).then(setCapped); // true: hide
    rwd.setMetadata({ surface: "account-menu-sidebar", proposal: "P3" });
    rwd.load({ charName: "AOL" }); // Game Partner
  }, [userId]);
  useEffect(() => {
    // Grant on REWARD_VERIFIED (server-verified), never on EARNED_REWARD.
    if (rwd.rewardVerified) grant({ amount: 10, resource: "News Credits", token:
rwd.rewardToken });
  }, [rwd.rewardVerified]);
  // no_fill or not loaded: render nothing; today's path is unchanged.
  if (capped || !rwd.isLoaded || rwd.error?.code === "no_fill") return null;
  // "No thanks" stays the app's own control: back to where the user was.
  return (
    <MiniGameButton
      text={"Play Now"}
      onClick={() => rwd.show()}
    />
  );
}
// Min play 15s is a unit setting (no RN load option; unverified).
// Needs <SimulaProvider apiKey={...}> at the root; grant() is your server call.
```

WHAT THE JUDGE CHANGED

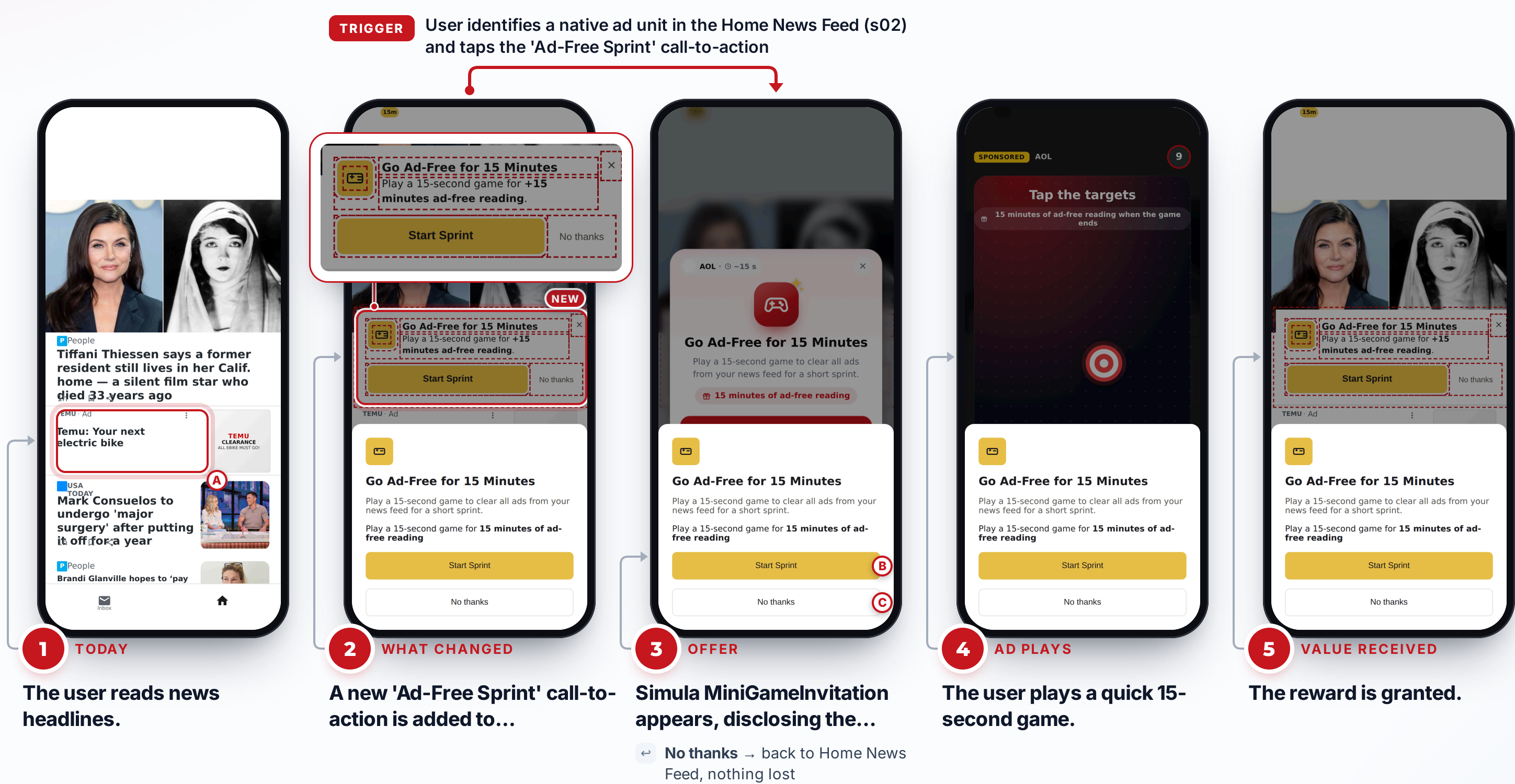
- Round 0 (v1) REVISE 4.00: Introducing a virtual currency ('News Credits') in a traditional news reader app with no prior scarcity requires... Required: Define and...

PRECEDENTS (KNOWLEDGE BASE)

- TAX-9** Daily quests, tasks and check-ins (sponsored tasks)
- TAX-2** Time-boxed premium unlock or trial ("sponsored session")
- EX-SERIAL** Serialized content: webtoons, audio drama, short drama
- AI-3**

Go Ad-Free for 15 Minutes

Enjoy 15 minutes of ad-free news reading after a quick game.



SHIP Score 4.20 / 5 (ship ≥ 3.8)

Product change

WHY THIS WORKS

\$0.009–\$0.015 per view

Earned per completed US view; the reward costs ≈ \$0 to serve.

Paid path untouched

The reward is strictly time-boxed to 15 minutes, serving as a 'taste of premium' sampling effect rather than a...

≤ 3 a day

Opt-in only, at least 1 h apart; nothing plays unless the user taps.

Open the clickable prototype →

Simula SIM-RWD · button entry · Game Partner: AOL · min play 15s · reward granted on REWARD_VERIFIED · frame callouts on slide 6

AOL Ad-Free Sprint

TRIGGER

User identifies a native ad unit in the Home News Feed (s02) and taps the 'Ad-Free Sprint' call-to-action.

ELIGIBILITY

Non-paying users currently exposed to standard ad density.

WHAT THE USER SEES

Go Ad-Free for 15 Minutes Play a 15-second game to clear all ads from your news feed for a short sprint.

Start Sprint

No thanks

REWARD AND CAPS

15 minutes of ad-free reading, 15 minutes; granted on REWARD_VERIFIED. At most 3 a day, 1 h apart.

FRAME BY FRAME (SLIDE 5)

- 1

Today

The user reads news headlines and encounters standard Taboola native advertisement units.
- A

User sees a native ad in the Home News Feed.
- 2

What changed

A new 'Ad-Free Sprint' call-to-action is added to the feed, offering an...

New Ad-Free Sprint entry point appears.
- 3

Offer

Simula MiniGameInvitation appears, disclosing the 15-second requirement and the 15-minute ad-free reward.

B

Start Sprint: starts a 15s sponsored game

C

No thanks: dismisses the offer

User taps to start the sprint.
- 4

Ad plays

The user plays a quick 15-second game with the AOL Game Partner...
- 5

Value received

The reward is granted; native ad units are suppressed via remote config...

Timer active; ads removed.

ECONOMICS (COMPUTED IN CODE)

Revenue per completed US view	\$0.009–\$0.015
Reward value at list price	n/a (no priced unit)
Reward ÷ one view	n/a
Max earnable per day (3/day)	n/a
Cheapest pack	none observed
Cost to serve the reward	\$0 per view

SCENARIO, NOT FORECAST

0.225

\$0.0027

\$985,500

views per DAU

ARPDau

per year per 1M DAU

Scenario, not a forecast: 15% of DAU engage, 1.5 views each, US mid eCPM after a 25% non-game haircut.

CANNIBALIZATION GUARD

The reward is strictly time-boxed to 15 minutes, serving as a 'taste of premium' sampling effect rather than a permanent replacement for ad-free tiers. Enforcement toggles ad rendering units via...

KPI AND HOLDOUT

Ad-free Sprint sessions started; guardrails: Daily active news reading time, Native ad CTR (non-sprint), D7 Retention. User-level holdout, 10% share, 21 days

RISKS

- Users may grow accustomed to ad-free reading and find the return to standard density jarring.
- Potential revenue dip if sprint sessions overlap with peak reading times.

INTEGRATION (@SIMULA/ADS-REACT-NATIVE)

```
import { SimulaAds, useRewardedAd, MiniGameButton } from "@simula/ads-react-native";
import { useEffect, useState } from "react";

// P2 on "Home News Feed". Trigger: User identifies a native ad unit in the Home News
Feed (s02) and taps the 'Ad-Free...
// Caps 3/day, 60 min apart: app remote config (unit cap: dashboard)
const AD_UNIT = "SIM-RWD-home-news-feed"; // placeholder: create it in the dashboard

export function AoIAdFreeOffer({ userId, partnerImageUrl, grant, onDecline }) {
  const rwd = useRewardedAd(AD_UNIT);
  const [capped, setCapped] = useState(true);
  useEffect(() => {
    SimulaAds.checkFrequencyCap(AD_UNIT, userId).then(setCapped); // true: hide
    rwd.setMetadata({ surface: "home-news-feed", proposal: "P2" });
    rwd.load({ charName: "AOL" }); // Game Partner
  }, [userId]);
  useEffect(() => {
    // Grant on REWARD_VERIFIED (server-verified), never on EARNED_REWARD.
    if (rwd.rewardVerified) grant({ amount: 15, resource: "Ad-free Sprint", duration:
"15 minutes", token: rwd.rewardToken });
  }, [rwd.rewardVerified]);
  // no_fill or not loaded: render nothing; today's path is unchanged.
  if (capped || !rwd.isLoaded || rwd.error?.code === "no_fill") return null;
  // "No thanks" stays the app's own control: back to where the user was.
  return (
    <MiniGameButton
      text={"Start Sprint"}
      onClick={() => rwd.show()}
    />
  );
}
// Min play 15s is a unit setting (no RN load option; unverified).
// Needs <SimulaProvider apiKey={...}> at the root; grant() is your server call.
```

WHAT THE JUDGE CHANGED

- Round 0 (v1) REVISE 3.65: The current trigger (Account Menu Sidebar) is buried and disconnected from the moment of friction (reading ads)... Required: Move or duplicate...

PRECEDENTS (KNOWLEDGE BASE)

- TAX-2** Time-boxed premium unlock or trial ("sponsored session")
- EX-MUSIC** Spotify and Pandora (audio; freemium subscription)
- CORE-2**

Ideas we rejected, and why

Every candidate the judge scored, with its final verdict. Only SHIP becomes a flow; REVISE is never promoted. Weighted score out of 5.

ID	IDEA	VERDICT	SCORE	WHY
P3	Daily Reader Streak & Ad-Free Access Product change	SHIP	4.80	SHIP at 4.8 (v2 after 1 revision). See slide 3.
P2	AOL Ad-Free Sprint Product change	SHIP	4.20	SHIP at 4.2 (v2 after 1 revision). See slide 5.
P1	AOL Guest Commenter Product change	REJECT	3.40	REJECT after 1 revision: revision stalled (weighted -1.2, below +0.2) with the same gate failures. Top concern: grounding (code): economy item "Account sign-in /...

Brainstormed, not developed: Headline Doubler · Saved List Expansion · Inbox Priority Pass · Sports Spotlight Session · Comment sample fallback

Obvious baseline the proposer had to go beyond: Watch a video to remove banner ads for 30 minutes of news reading. · Watch an ad to unlock a 'Premium' news article otherwise hidden behind a wall. · Watch a video to earn 100 generic coins for a new profile customization shop.

Method and mock fidelity

- 1. **Explore.** 60 steps, 17 states, 58 edges, 1 external surface in 8 min; stopped: budget steps. 72 actions deliberately not explored.
- 2. **Understand.** 17 screens in the product model; 8 claims verified against on-screen text, 0 inferred. Synthesized by llm.
- 3. **Mock + QA.** 33% of screens rebuilt in HTML; 22/22 navigation flows pass.
- 4. **Propose.** 8 ideas, 3 developed into typed proposals (patch, storyboard, assumptions). Generated by llm.
- 5. **Judge.** 6 judgment rounds for 3 proposals: code gates first, then a rubric scored by llm; the verdict is computed in code (ship ≥ 3.8 , every criterion ≥ 3 , ≤ 2 rounds).
- 6. **Slides.** Every frame is a screenshot of the patched mock driven through its runtime API; callouts sit on measured DOM positions; numbers come from economics code.

QA FIDELITY (MOCK VS THE REAL SCREENSHOTS)

MEAN COMPOSITE		FLOW PASS RATE		HTML SCREENS	
0.77		100%		33%	
SCREEN	RENDER	COMPOSITE	ROUNDS	MUST-FIX	
Home News Feed	html	0.73	1	0	
Home News Feed	html	0.79	1	1	
Article Details	image	–	0	0	
Conversation Screen	image	–	0	0	
Add Comment Page	image	–	0	0	
Sign In Screen	image	–	0	0	
Home News Feed	html	0.65	1	1	
Home News Feed	image	–	0	0	
Saved Articles	image	–	0	0	
Search Suggestions	image	–	0	0	
Account Menu Sidebar	image	–	0	0	
No Contacts	image	–	0	0	

Cost and limitations

MODEL SPEND FOR THIS APP (FROM COST.JSONL)

STAGE	LIVE CALLS	CACHED	TOKENS IN	TOKENS OUT	USD
explore	29	0	114.0k	8.5k	\$0
understand	1	0	20.1k	1.4k	\$0
mock	7	0	56.7k	95.4k	\$0
qa	4	0	41.3k	61.1k	\$0
propose	26	11	1.4M	101.5k	\$0
judge	26	6	1.4M	80.1k	\$0
slides	2	4	18.9k	21.5k	\$0
Total	95	21	3.1M	369.5k	\$0

Gemini free tier: calls cost \$0; tokens are still logged. Models: gemini-3.5-flash-lite, gemini-3.1-flash-lite, gemini-3-flash-preview, gemini-2.5-flash. Cached calls replay from disk at no cost.

LIMITATIONS

- Explored on an Android emulator (logged-in account); 72 actions left unexplored by guard rails or scope, listed in the model viewer.
- 0 product-model claims inferred rather than observed; the economy review is the human checkpoint for them.
- Revenue per view uses KB eCPM ranges with a non-game haircut; some constants are inferred. ARPDau appears only as a labelled scenario.
- The ad in the frames is simulated by the mock; real fill, creatives and completion rates vary by market.
- The judge is a separate call of the same model family as the proposer; its single-fault calibration table is in judge-eval.md.

How this runs across hundreds of apps

Storage and versioning

- Screenshots, element lists and HTML are content-addressed blobs; artifact JSON references them by hash.
- A model version is keyed by package, version code and a UI fingerprint of the core flows, which also catches over-the-air updates.
- A diff between two model versions (screens, walls, prices, offers) is itself a sales signal.

When to re-explore

- Daily store version poll; weekly no-LLM smoke replay of the core flows and the path to the wall.
- Drift above 10% or any price change triggers an incremental re-explore from the known graph (about 20% of first-run cost).
- A new ad format re-runs only propose and judge.

Where humans review

- App onboarding and login (15 min); economy review, the highest-leverage step (10 min).
- Deck approval before any customer sees it (15–30 min); exception queue for blocked apps.
- Monthly judge audit against labelled outcomes.

Cost and sales fit

- Prospect scan without a mock ≈ \$5 of model calls; full pitch pack ≈ \$20–25 plus 45–60 min of human review.
- The deck, clickable prototype and sizing sheet attach to the CRM deal; each SHIP's integration snippet becomes the implementation ticket.
- Post-launch opt-in, completion and IAP guardrails flow back to recalibrate economics and the judge.